

SBGP – MWBE Information Process Mapping

Final Project Presentation

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UMD iConsultancy
INST490: Capstone
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Project Objectives



1. Analyze SBGP's current MWBE compliance process
2. Identify workflow inefficiencies and communication gaps
3. Improve vendor experience and submission clarity
4. Reduce administrative bottlenecks and manual rework
5. Explore opportunities for process standardization and automation

Deliverables



1. Current “As-Is” Workflow



2. Optimized “To-Be” Workflow



3. Vendor Submission Checklist



4. Vendor Compliance Guide



5. Improved Budget Template



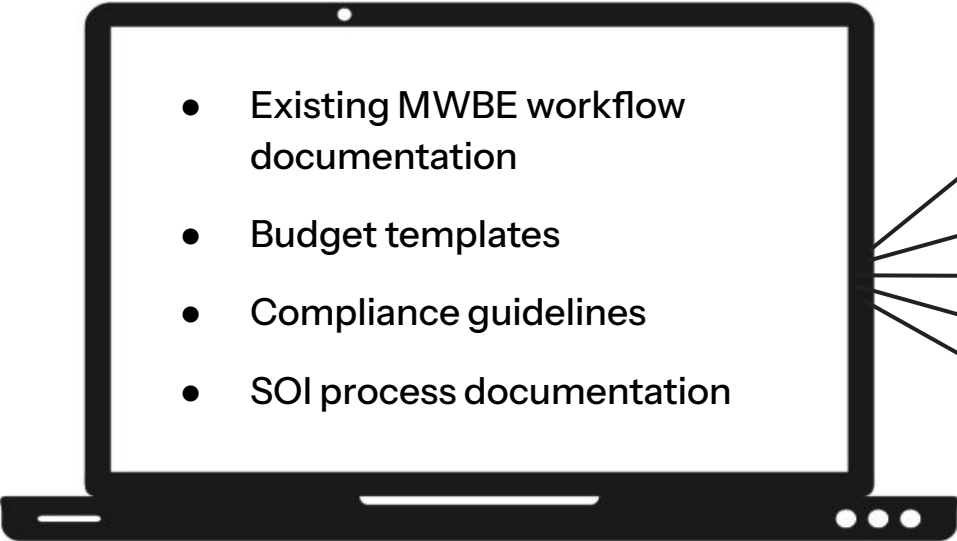
6. Technical Tools Integration

Research

Initial Client Meeting

Operations Team Meeting

Programs Team Meeting

- 
- Existing MWBE workflow documentation
 - Budget templates
 - Compliance guidelines
 - SOI process documentation

Vendor confusion around requirements

Inconsistent communication

High revision rates (80%)

Manual tracking challenges

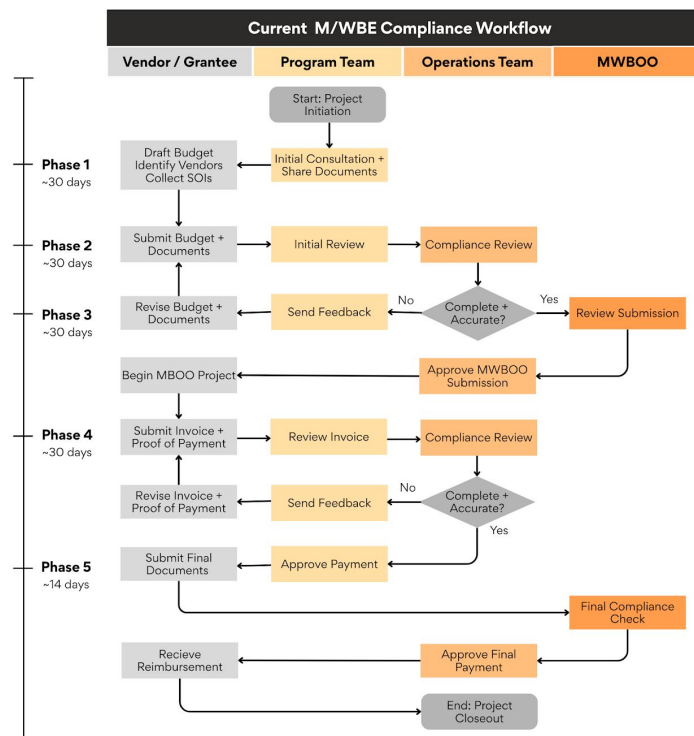
Delays caused by incomplete documentation

Current “As-Is” Workflow

Existing Process	Key Paint Points
• Budget preparation • Vendor search & SOIs • Internal review cycles • MWBOO approval • Ongoing compliance tracking • Final closeout	• Multiple revision cycles • Communication gaps • Manual tracking • Limited onboarding structure • Delayed approvals

Current “As-Is” Workflow

Document



Current Workflow Pain Points

Problem	Impact
Incomplete submissions	Delays & repeated revisions
Inconsistent communication	Vendor confusion
Manual tracking	Administrative overhead
Scattered documentation	Difficult compliance monitoring
Unclear onboarding	Heavy staff reliance



Optimized Workflow Improvements

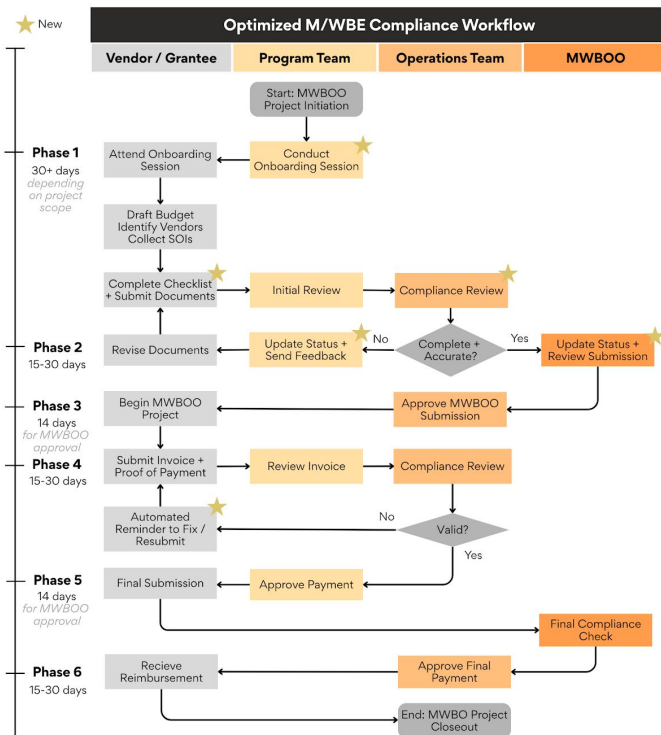
Current State	Proposed Improvement
Email-heavy submissions	Structured submission workflow
Repeated revision cycles	Early validation + standardized reviews
Scattered communication	Centralized tracking system
Vendor confusion	Simplified onboarding materials
Manual compliance tracking	Dashboard + automated reminders

Optimized “To-Be” Workflow

Design Principles	Key Improvements
• Standardization • Early validation • Reduced rework • Centralized communication • Vendor clarity	• Structured onboarding • Guided submission process • Standardized review checkpoints • Centralized tracking • Improved compliance monitoring

Optimized “To-Be” Workflow

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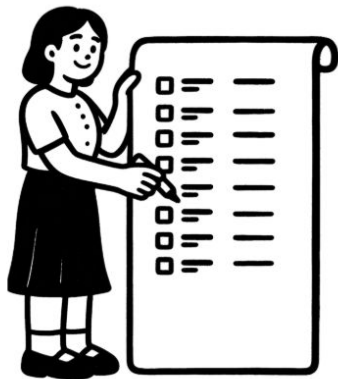


Vendor Submission Checklist

Key Features	Impact
• Structured submission steps • Vendor search documentation requirements • Budget + SOI alignment guidance • Compliance reminders • Final closeout requirements	• Reduces incomplete submissions • Improves consistency • Creates clearer expectations

Vendor Submission Checklist

Document



SBGP MWBE Compliance Submission Checklist

Instructions

All vendors and grantees must complete the following requirements to comply with the City of Baltimore's Minority- and Women-Owned Business Enterprise (MWBE) participation guidelines. Incomplete or inaccurate submissions may result in delays in review, contract execution, reimbursement, or final payment.

Step 1: Get Started

- ☐ Review all materials provided by SBGP:
 - Budget template
 - Statement of Intent (SOI) forms
 - MWBE compliance guidelines
- ☐ Understand your project:
 - Scope of work
 - Budget
 - Timeline and project milestones
- ☐ Understand participation goals:
 - 27% MBE participation of total contract award
 - 10% WBE participation of total contract award

Vendor Compliance Guide Improvements

Existing Challenges

- Wordy policy-based language
- Difficult to navigate
- Limited onboarding guidance
- Unclear documentation and timeline expectations
- Reliance on staff for clarification

Enhancements

- Plain-language expectations
- Step-by-step navigation
- Clear submission process guidelines
- Clarified timeline and approval expectations
- Search tips, instructions, and definitions

Previous Vendor Compliance Guide

Document



SOUTH BALTIMORE
GATEWAY PARTNERSHIP 

GUIDELINES FOR COMPLIANCE WITH CITY OF BALTIMORE MBE AND WBE PARTICIPATION

Overview

SBGP is required by law to adhere to the City of Baltimore's "Guidelines for MBE and WBE Participation." Therefore, all SBGP grantees awarded and vendors contracted for projects \$50,000 or more are required by law to meet participation goals for the utilization of minority-owned and women-owned business enterprises (MBEs and WBEs) as determined by the City of Baltimore Minority and Women's Business Opportunity Office (MWBOO). This policy also reflects SBGP's commitment to equity and its social and economic development goals by promoting the participation of local minority- and women-owned businesses.

With rare exceptions, SBGP will not execute a contract/ agreement with a vendor or grantee required to meet MBE/WBE participation goals until a budget and a plan for meeting anticipated goals have been provided to SBGP (for submission to the MWBOO). SBGP will sign a contract/grant agreement after receiving a response from the MWBOO with goals for the project or two weeks has passed since the budget was submitted to the MWBOO for review.

In cases where it is not possible to do this in advance of signing a contract/grant agreement, vendor/grantee will follow the MWBOO's default goals of 27% MBE participation and 10% WBE participation.

By law, SBGP is responsible for ensuring that the City's MBE/WBE participation goals are met, as articulated in your contract/grant agreement. SBGP reserves the right to withhold payments for grant-related activities unless or until a satisfactory plan is in place and being followed to meet MBE/WBE participation goals and compliance requirements.

Summary of Compliance Requirements

SBGP will meet with each affected vendor or grantee individually to strategize on appropriate goal-setting and how to achieve it. What follows is a summary of steps in the process.

1. Timeline.

a) Draft Submission. All vendors and grantees are expected to work with their SBGP project manager to prepare their project budget for submission to the MWBOO. This includes providing detailed descriptions of each line item in the budget, researching potential vendors, and obtaining signed Statement of Intent (SOI) forms from vendors, as needed. This process can take several



Improved Vendor Compliance Guide

Document



SOUTH BALTIMORE
GATEWAY PARTNERSHIP



SBGP MWBE Compliance Guide for Vendors A Step-by-Step Guide to Meeting City of Baltimore Requirements

Overview:

This guide helps vendors and grantees understand the City of Baltimore's MWBE compliance requirements for projects funded through South Baltimore Gateway Partnership (SBGP).

This guide explains:

- What documents are required
- How to prepare your submission
- How the review process works
- Common mistakes to avoid
- How to stay compliant throughout your project



Quick Start: What You Need to Do

If your project is \$50,000 or more, you are required to meet MWBE participation goals.

Before submitting your project, you must:

Budget Template Improvements

Existing Challenges

- Difficult to interpret
- Limited guidance
- Confusing documentation expectations
- Cluttered content

Enhancements

- Instructional tab
- Column descriptions
- Clarified vendor search tracking
- Improved payment verification guidance
- Organized content

Data validation ▼



Improved Budget Template

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	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1												
2		SBCP MWBE Compliance Budget Template										
3		This budget template is designed to help vendors and grantees prepare a complete and compliant submission for the Minority and Women's Business Enterprise (MWBE) participation requirements set by the City of Baltimore.										
4		This spreadsheet incorporates parts of the MWBE compliance process, from initial budget development through final payment verification. It should be completed alongside the required documentation (e.g., Statements of Intent).										
5												
6		How to Use This Template										
7		This spreadsheet includes four tabs that must be completed and maintained throughout your project:										
8												
9		1. Project Budget										
10		→ List all project budget line items										
11		→ Identify whether each cost is discretionary or non-discretionary										
12		→ Document any exclusion requests with justification										
13		→ Determine which costs are subject to MBE/WBE participation goals										
14		<i>* Participation goals (typically 27% MBE and 10% WBE) are calculated automatically based on eligible costs</i>										
15												
16		2. Statement of Intent Log										
17		→ Record all selected MBE/WBE vendors										
18		→ Track planned vs. actual participation amounts										
19		→ Monitor whether participation goals are being met										

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Instructions

Project Budget

Statement of Intent Log

Payment Verification Log

Data Validation

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Technical Tool Integration

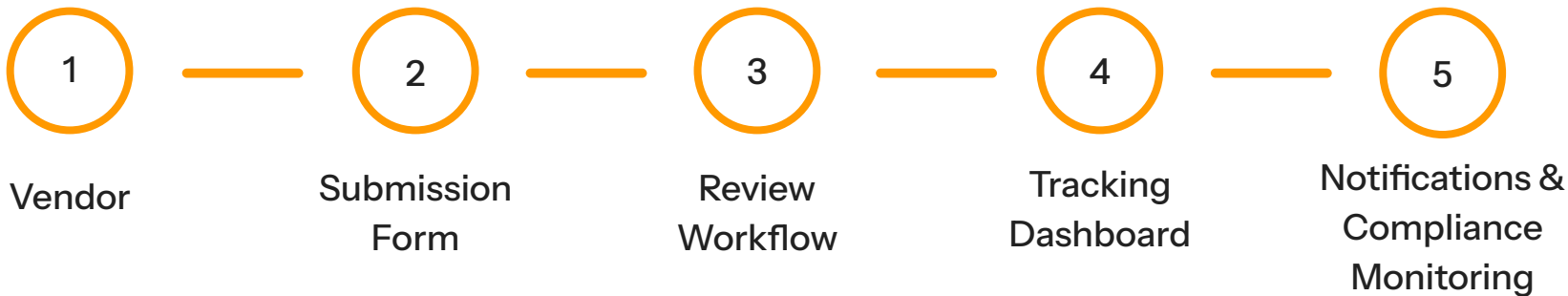
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Opportunities for Tool Integration	Proposed Solutions	Recommended Tools
• Incomplete submissions • Limited workflow tracking • Fragmented communication • Manual monitoring	• Guided submission form • Workflow tracking • Automated notifications • Centralized dashboard	• <i>Power Apps</i> → Vendor submission form • <i>SharePoint</i> → Centralized storage + tracking • <i>Power Automate</i> → Workflow automation + notifications

Technical Tool Integration

Document



Technical Tool Integration

Document



SBGP MWBE Technical Tool Integration Plan

For Compliance Process Optimization

1. Overview

This document outlines recommended technical solutions to support SBGP's MWBE compliance workflow. These recommendations aim to:

- Reduce manual effort and administrative overhead
- Improve vendor submission quality and consistency
- Increase transparency across teams
- Enable scalable, long-term process improvements

All recommendations are tool-agnostic and aligned with:

- SBGP's current use of *Asana*
- SBGP's planned transition to a *Salesforce* CRM system

2. Key Challenges Identified

2.1 Incomplete & Inconsistent Submissions

- Vendors submit documents via email with missing or unclear information
- ~80% of submissions require revisions
- No standardized intake structure

Project Impact

Vendors

- Clearer guidance
- Reduced confusion
- Faster submission process

Overall Compliance

- Reduced revision cycles
- Improved documentation accuracy
- Better long-term process scalability

SBGP Staff

- Reduced administrative overhead
- Improved communication
- Easier compliance tracking
- Standardized workflows

Future Recommendations

Short-Term

- Implement standardized onboarding process
- Use revised checklist + templates
- Improve documentation consistency



Mid-Term

- Centralize workflow tracking
- Standardize review procedures
- Introduce automated notifications



Long-Term

- Fully Integrate workflows into Salesforce CRM
- Develop vendor-facing submission portal
- Expand compliance tracking & analytics

Questions?



Thank You from the UMD iConsultancy Team:

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